

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 4 2
♥ A J 10 6 4
♦ K J 10
♣ 5 3

♠ K 10

♥ 8 5 2

♦ A 7 4

♣ A K Q 9 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 9 7 5 3

♥ K 9

♦ 9 6 3

♣ J 10 4

♠ A J 6

♥ Q 7 3

♦ Q 8 5 2

♣ 7 6 2

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North

Assuming the ♣s behave you need to get one more winner. It's possible you could lead toward dummy's ♦Q but even if it works they would probably attack ♥s. Your best chance of getting an extra trick lies in the ♠ suit.

It is almost certain that East holds the ♠Q. Of course defenders sometimes don't lead according to the guidelines, but if West had the ♠Q he would likely have played it at the first trick. In addition, the Rule of 11 tells you there were 6 cards in the South, West and North hands higher than the ♠5. You can account for all of them, so East must have the ♠Q. In that case you can assure the contract by winning the first trick with the ♠K rather than the ♠10. In this way you will be able to gain a trick by finessing East for the ♠Q. It's true that if you won with the ♠10 you would still have both the ♠K and ♠A remaining, but you wouldn't have the dummy entry you needed.

With the unfortunate placement of red cards the only way you can enjoy 3 ♠ tricks is to take your ♠K on the first trick and later finesse East for the ♠Q.

Notice how strange this game can be. If your holding was ♠ K 2 rather than ♠ K 10 you would have had no difficulty coming up with the correct play. But the fact that you can win a cheap trick with the ♠10 tries to lure you into making an inferior play.

With a balanced, 17 point hand you open 1NT. Partner responds 2NT.

You were invited to bid 3NT if you have a maximum opener. With 17 points you accept the invitation.

North plays 3NT. East leads ♠5. You put on dummy's ♠6 and West plays the ♠8.

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Winner count: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 5 : Total = 8

The good news is that they didn't lead a ♥. The bad news is that if you give up the lead they probably will.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 6 4
♥ K 6 2
♦ Q 6 2
♣ J 7 5 3

♠ 8 7

♥ 10 9

♦ A K J 7 3

♣ Q 10 6 2



♠ A K Q 5 3

♥ A Q 7 3

♦ 5 4

♣ A 8

♠ J 10 2

♥ J 8 5 4

♦ 10 9 8

♣ K 9 4

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

evenly to give you a fourth ♥ trick. In fact, there is a chance that you might ruff the fourth ♥.

Play exactly two rounds of trumps with the ♠A and ♠K. Then play ♥K, ♥A and ♥Q. If both defenders follow to three leads your fourth ♥ is good so you pull the last trump. If somebody shows out on the third lead and does not ruff then play your last ♥ and ruff in dummy. Return to your hand with the ♣A and pull trumps.

You will always make the contract when ♥s split 3-3.

By pulling exactly 2 rounds of trumps first you can also succeed in the case where ♥s split 4-2 and the defender with the doubleton ♥ also has a doubleton trump.

You have a nice hand, but can only open 1 ♠.

Partner raises to 2 ♠.

Partner has 6-10 points, you have 20 points.

The math works so you bid 4 ♠.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads the ♦10, you cover and North plays the three high ♦s.

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Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

To start with, you ruff the third ♦. You cannot avoid the ♣ loser, so you might think that ♥s must break